

Sep 28, 2026

Review Call

Invited Dr. Zaibis Muñoz-Isme Ajlan Okman Laura Barcellos Sait Yucekaya

Attachments 📅 Review Call

Meeting records 📄 Transcript 🎙️ Recording

Summary

UI design discussion via competitor analysis and prioritization of institutional sales.

UI Layout and Categorization

List view design selected over Kanban. Standardized task categorization icons established.

Competitive Analysis and Gamification

Gamification and critical path analysis identified as key selling points against legacy systems.

Workflow and Design Alignment

Temporary pause on asynchronous work implemented for discovery tasks requiring mandatory checkpoints.

Decisions

Aligned

- **Inclusion of task card due dates** The team agreed to display due dates and estimated completion times side-by-side on each task card.

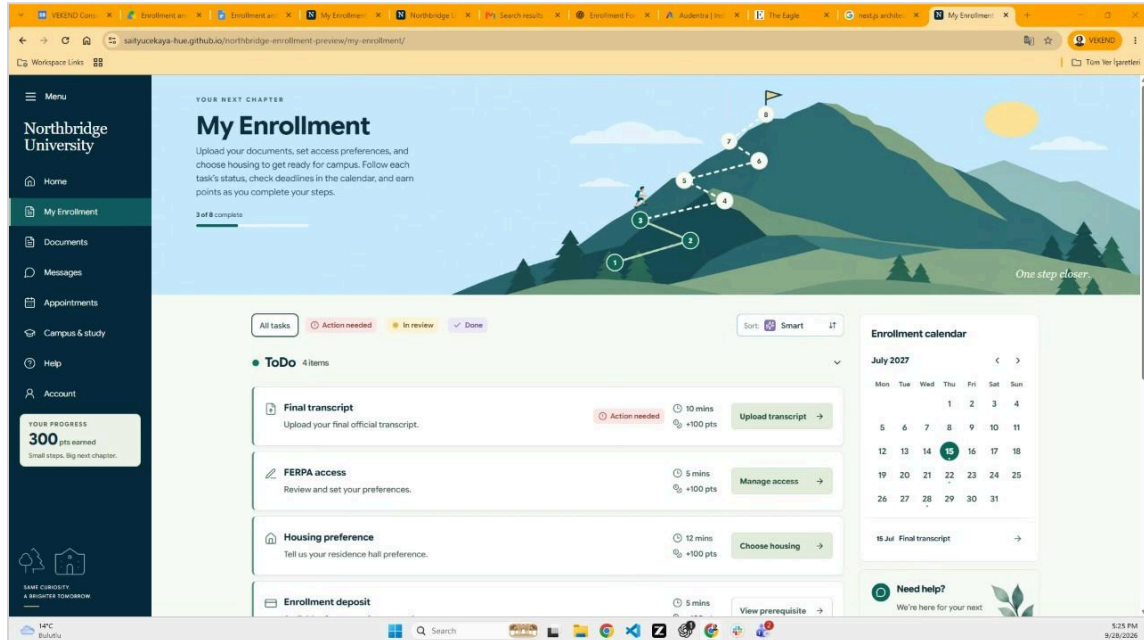
- **Standardization of task type icons** The participants aligned on using consistent UI icons categorized by specific task types across the platform.
- **Integration of point of contact** The team agreed to include a designated point of contact on the student interface to address feelings of disconnection.

Next steps

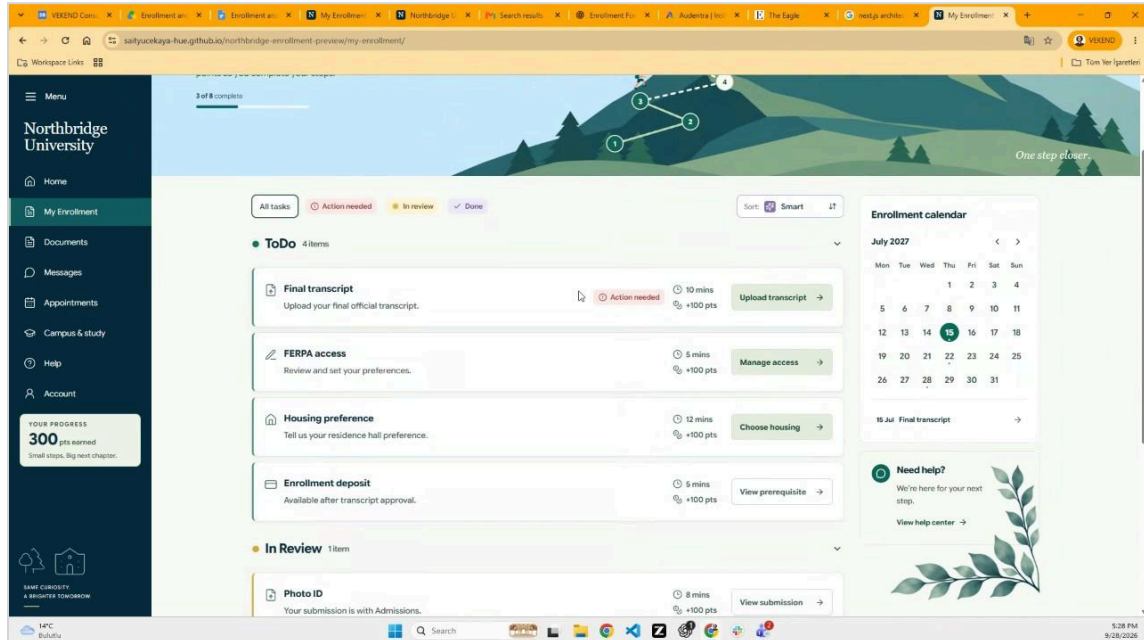
- ☐ [Sait Yucekaya] Add Metadata to UI: Incorporate due dates and estimated completion times into the task cards to improve user awareness of deadlines.
- ☐ [Sait Yucekaya] Update Task Icons: Implement standardized icons across all task types to signify specific actions such as document uploads, reviews, payments, and form completions.
- ☐ [Sait Yucekaya] Create User Tour: Build an onboarding walkthrough tour that guides students through the task sorting, gamification, and support features.
- ☐ [Laura Barcellos, Ajlan Okman] Review Design System: Conduct a review meeting to discuss the current design system documentation and address missing elements.

Details

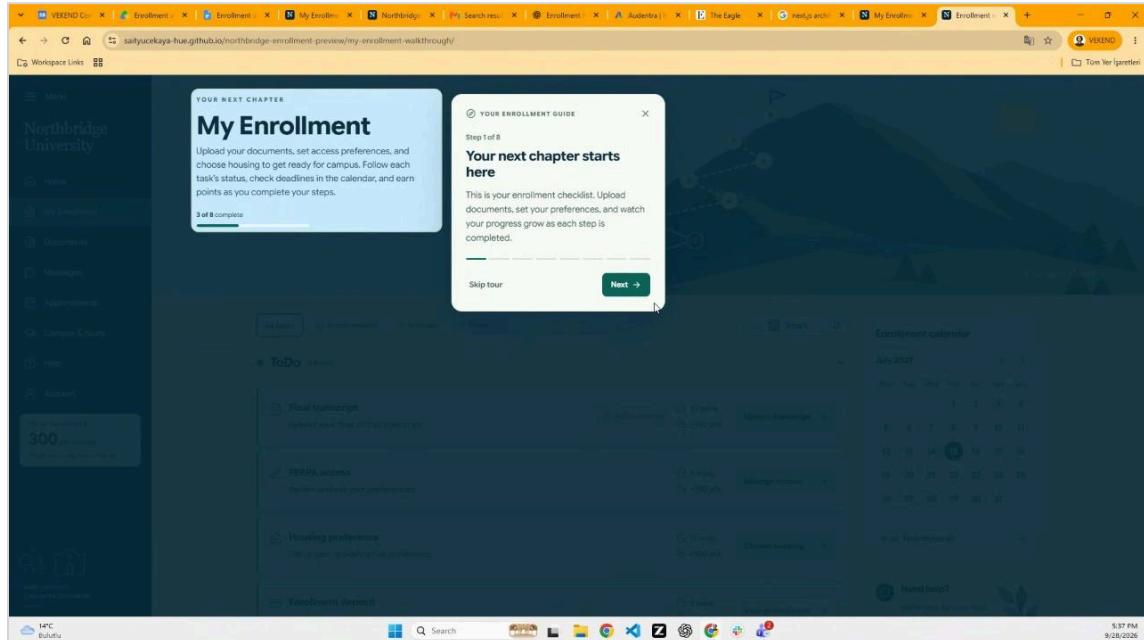
- **UI Layout and Sorting Options:** Sait Yucekaya presented a list view design influenced by mobile and web developers, explaining that to-do apps on Google Play and the App Store typically use list views rather than Kanban styles ([00:01:19](#)). Ajlan Okman suggested replacing the sorting drop-down with interactive chips so users can directly choose between smart AI sorting, due date sorting, and action-needed views ([00:00:00](#)). Ajlan Okman questioned the distinction between "action needed" and "to-do" statuses, prompting Sait Yucekaya to explain that "action needed" items typically appear after a rejection or failure requiring re-upload or re-checking. Ajlan Okman concluded that clearer UX definitions are needed for these states ([00:02:20](#)).



- Dashboard Missing Elements and Task Categorization Icons:** Ajlan Okman pointed out that due dates and estimated completion times are missing from the current design and must be added side-by-side with action buttons that display potential earned loyalty points (00:03:26). Regarding task categorization, Ajlan Okman and Sait Yucekaya agreed to standardize task-type icons so that all document uploads share one icon, all review-and-sign tasks share another, payments share a third, and forms or housing selections share a fourth (00:05:52). Ajlan Okman requested more visibility into the smart sorting logic to build institutional trust, while Sait Yucekaya noted that students only need to see recommended selections and prerequisite sequences (00:07:13).

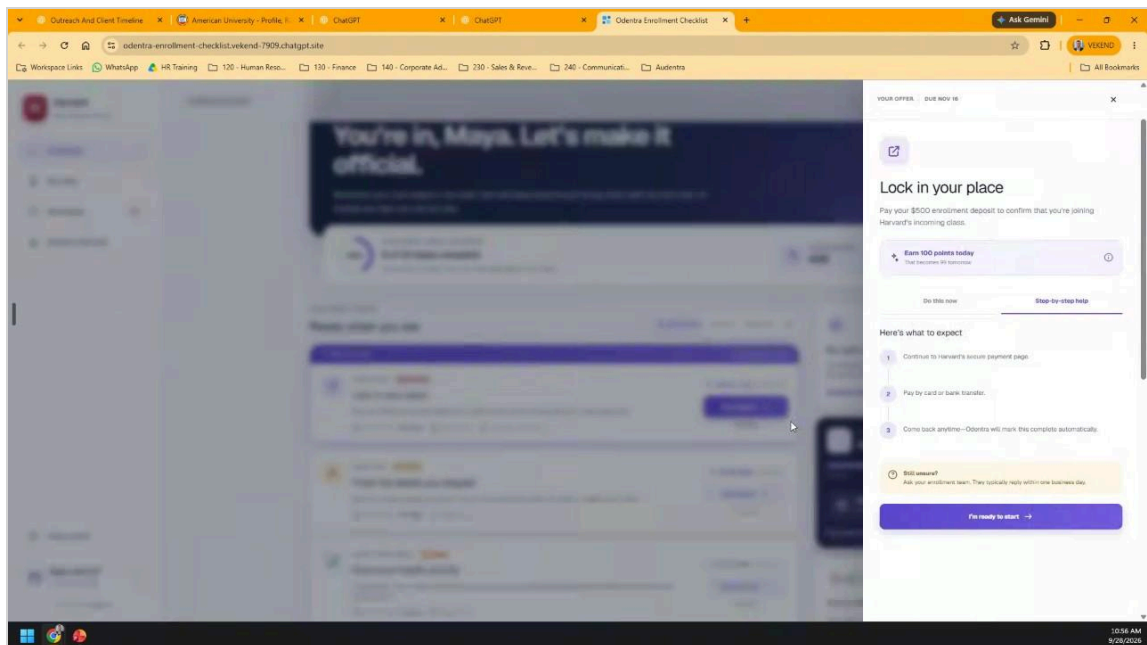


- Competitive Landscape and Institutional Software Analysis:** Dr. Zaibis Muñoz-Isme evaluated competitor tracking systems used by colleges, noting that institutions currently rely on platforms such as Salesforce, Slate, Illusion, Banner, Workday Student, Colleague, and EAB Navigate, though poor adoption often limits their usefulness (00:08:28). Dr. Zaibis Muñoz-Isme emphasized that to convince universities to abandon these legacy systems, the product must look clean, be easy to learn, and avoid feeling overly complex like HubSpot (00:09:38). Sait Yucekaya mentioned implementing a step-by-step walkthrough tour—based on feedback received from Shan—to help users understand the platform interface (00:10:38).

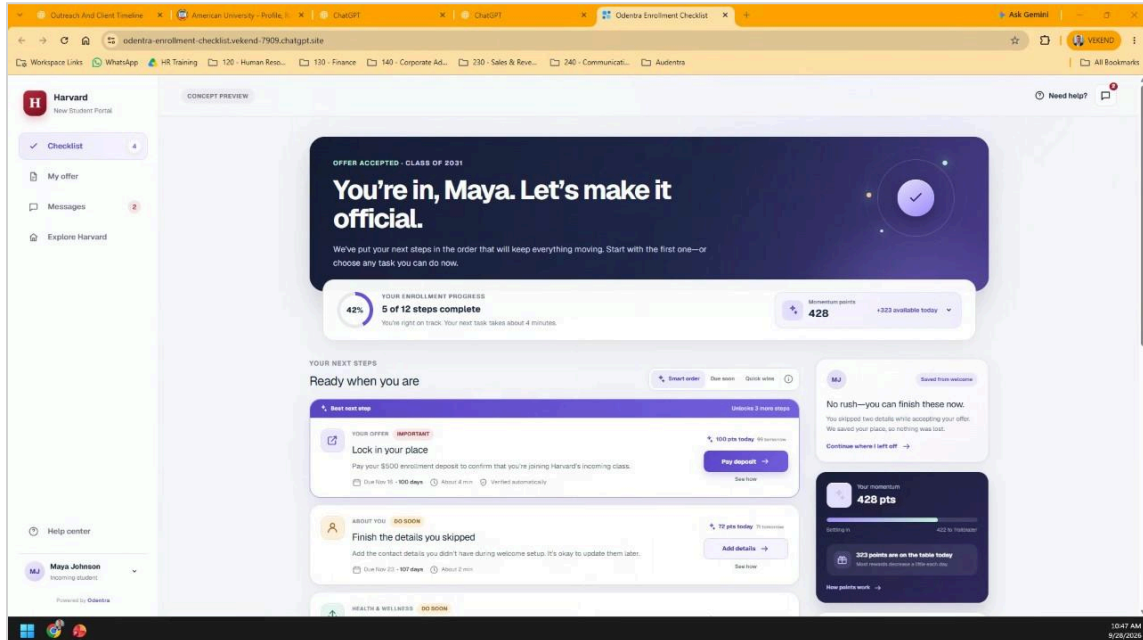


- Gamification and Balancing Student Versus Institutional Needs:** Ajlan Okman and Dr. Zaibis Muñoz-Isme stressed that gamification features, such as earning North Bridge points redeemable for bookstore credits, and critical path analysis are primary selling points that set the platform apart from competitors like Banner and Slate (00:11:34) (00:16:48). Dr. Zaibis Muñoz-Isme expressed concern that making the interface too basic would diminish its market value to institutional IT buyers who expect sophisticated tools (00:21:09). Sait Yucekaya questioned whether the primary client is the student or the institution, while Ajlan Okman argued that marketing must first appeal to paying institutional clients and parents who ultimately decide to replace existing contracts (00:15:31) (00:23:07).
- Dashboard Aesthetics and Visual Hierarchy:** Ajlan Okman praised the visual hierarchy of the ChatGPT-assisted design, noting features like small icons, due dates, completion time estimates, and an enrollment calendar on the right side (00:25:19). Laura Barcellos confirmed that standardized UI elements and color-coding for past-due items had already been developed over the weekend (00:26:23). Ajlan Okman emphasized that every pixel must communicate why the platform is superior to legacy systems like Banner, Salesforce, and Illusion (00:12:46) (00:24:11).
- Onboarding Walkthrough and Support Features:** Ajlan Okman outlined the required sequence for the platform onboarding walkthrough: starting with task

sorting and unlocking prerequisites, followed by explaining point conversion rules where points have monetary value that decreases daily, step-by-step directions, accessing Edward AI assistance, and contacting the designated point of contact to schedule a meeting (00:29:57). Dr. Zaibis Muñoz-Isme highlighted that students often complete these steps with parents looking over their shoulder, making the repeatable tour feature essential (00:29:01).



- **User Comprehension and Target Audience Analysis:** Sait Yucekaya raised concerns about whether less tech-savvy Gen Z students will successfully navigate the sophisticated interface without friction, referencing past user testing conducted with Garrick (00:32:31). Laura Barcellos and Ajlan Okman noted that Garrick had previously helped improve terminology and wording currently used in production (00:33:44). Ajlan Okman reiterated that the current focus is delivering a robust product that vice presidents will purchase, after which future iterations can incorporate further UX testing with students (00:32:31).



- **Team Workflow, Design Systems, and Communication Protocols:**

Addressing inconsistencies in form fields and spacing, Ajlan Okman expressed frustration with asynchronous workflows and requested tighter collaboration and centralized design system alignment with Laura Barcellos and Dr. Zaibis Muñoz-Isme. Ajlan Okman outlined five levels of autonomy—ranging from autocratic execution to independent action—and noted that UI tasks fell under research and report, requiring mandatory peer review checkpoints rather than independent final reporting. Laura Barcellos noted the heavy existing meeting load, but following discussion, Ajlan Okman called for a temporary pause on asynchronous work for discovery tasks, requiring frequent 15-minute review checkpoints until all participants aligned on the design system ([00:34:54](#)) ([00:37:04](#)).

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